



The Best Places to Eat Carciofi alla Giudia

Da Giggetto moderate

You'd be hard put to find a more pleasant place to have dinner on a balmy summer's evening in Rome than this venerated trattoria in the city's ancient Ghetto district, not far from the banks of the Tiber River. "Giggetto" was the nickname of Luigi Ceccarelli, a returned WWI serviceman who began this well-reputed trattoria back in 1923, and the current manager is his grandson. Dining is alfresco from spring through fall, a memorable experience as the tables are set up between shiny stone columns belonging to the Porticus of Octavia, steeped in history. Inside, old brick vaults and arches dangle with braids of garlic and dried herbs over spacious rooms. A bowl of plump globe artichokes in the entrance informs diners that the traditional Jewish-Roman dish – golden, crisp *carciofi alla giudia* – is available. Another typical offering here is *filetto di baccalà*, fillet of salt cod, battered, fried, and served hot with lemon.

Via Portico d'Ottavia 21/22, Rome; open 12:30–2:30 PM & 7:30–11 PM Tue–Sun; www.giggetto.it

Also in Rome

With long lines outside its otherwise inconspicuous entrance, **Sora Margherita** (+39 06 687 4216; *inexpensive*) is a tiny trattoria in the Ghetto. Once inside, you'll be elbow-to-elbow with other guests. However, it is well worth the wait – nobody ever complains about the food, especially the antipasto, which includes *carciofi alla giudia*, given rave reviews by guests new and old.

Also in Italy

The island of Sant'Erasmo in the Venetian lagoon is a giant vegetable garden, which has supplied Venice with flavorful fresh produce since ancient Roman times. The menu at **Ristorante Cà Vignotto** (+39 41 24 44 000; *moderate*) on the island is dictated by the seasons, with winter to spring bringing the best *castraure* artichokes. With a bit of luck, their divine gnocchi with crab will be on the day's menu as well.

Around the World

Roman-style crisp-fried artichokes are one of the signature dishes of flamboyant master-chef Sandro Fioriti at his newest restaurant, **Sandro's** (www.sandrosnyc.com; *expensive*), which attracts a cultlike following among New Yorkers. Another house specialty is *spaghettini al limone*, which can be varied with a melon or tomato sauce.